

What 1,000 Verified Startups Reveal About Real Revenue

Every figure is recomputed from the TrustMRR 1,000-row dataset, frozen 30 Jul 2026. Every dollar of revenue was verified at the source via a live payment-provider API key.

1,000

Verified-revenue startups

\$13.47M

Total dataset MRR

30 Jul 2026

Snapshot frozen

Read time ~ 8 minutes. Discussion follows.

What TrustMRR actually is

SO WHAT Survey self-report lies. Live API revenue doesn't.



1,000

Verified-revenue startups

Every listing submitted a working API key from a supported payment provider.



\$13.47M

Total MRR under measurement

Stripe, RevenueCat, Paddle, Lemon Squeezy, Polar, Dodo, Whop and others.



30 Jul 2026

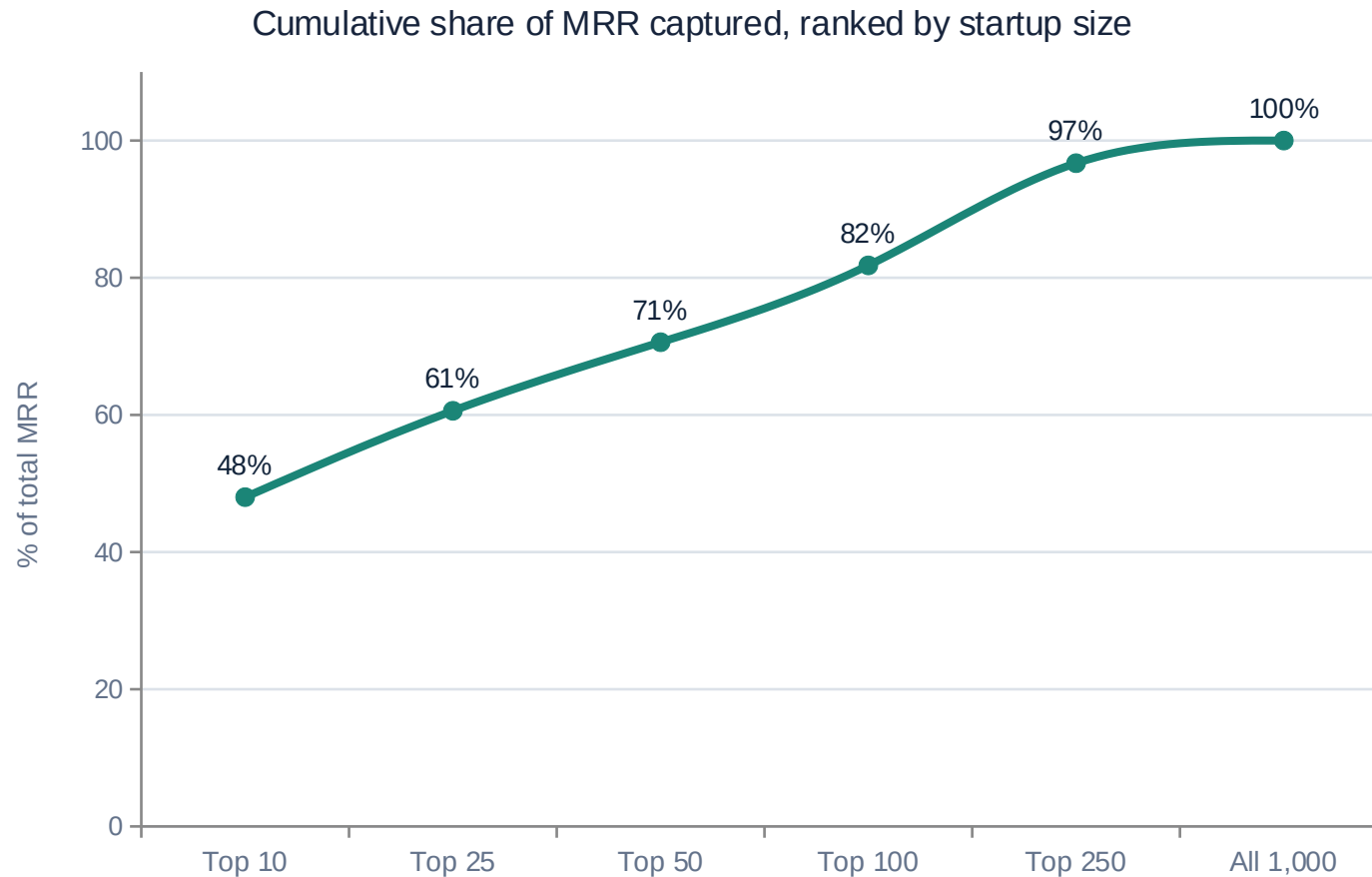
Point-in-time snapshot

Not a rolling window. Every chart in this deck reads from this single freeze.

- Verification via live API keys rules out fabrication. We are measuring revenue a buyer can independently assert.
- Dataset skews toward micro/SMB SaaS, AI tools, and mobile apps — not the universe of all startups.
- Point-in-time matters: revenue moved between this freeze and the next.

Revenue is winner-take-most

SO WHAT Real revenue lives in a small number of listings. The long tail hides it.



DATASET TOTAL

\$13.47M

MRR across 1,000 startups

Top 10 = 47%

\$6.46M earned by 1% of listings

Top 100 = 82%

\$11.02M earned by 10% of listings

Top 250 = 97%

Bottom 750 earn just 3% of MRR

Mean lies. Median tells the truth.

SO WHAT Skew means the 'average' startup is doing far better than almost anyone.



MEAN vs MEDIAN

Mean MRR

\$13,472

Median MRR

\$282

Mean is 48× the median.

19.7% earn \$0/month

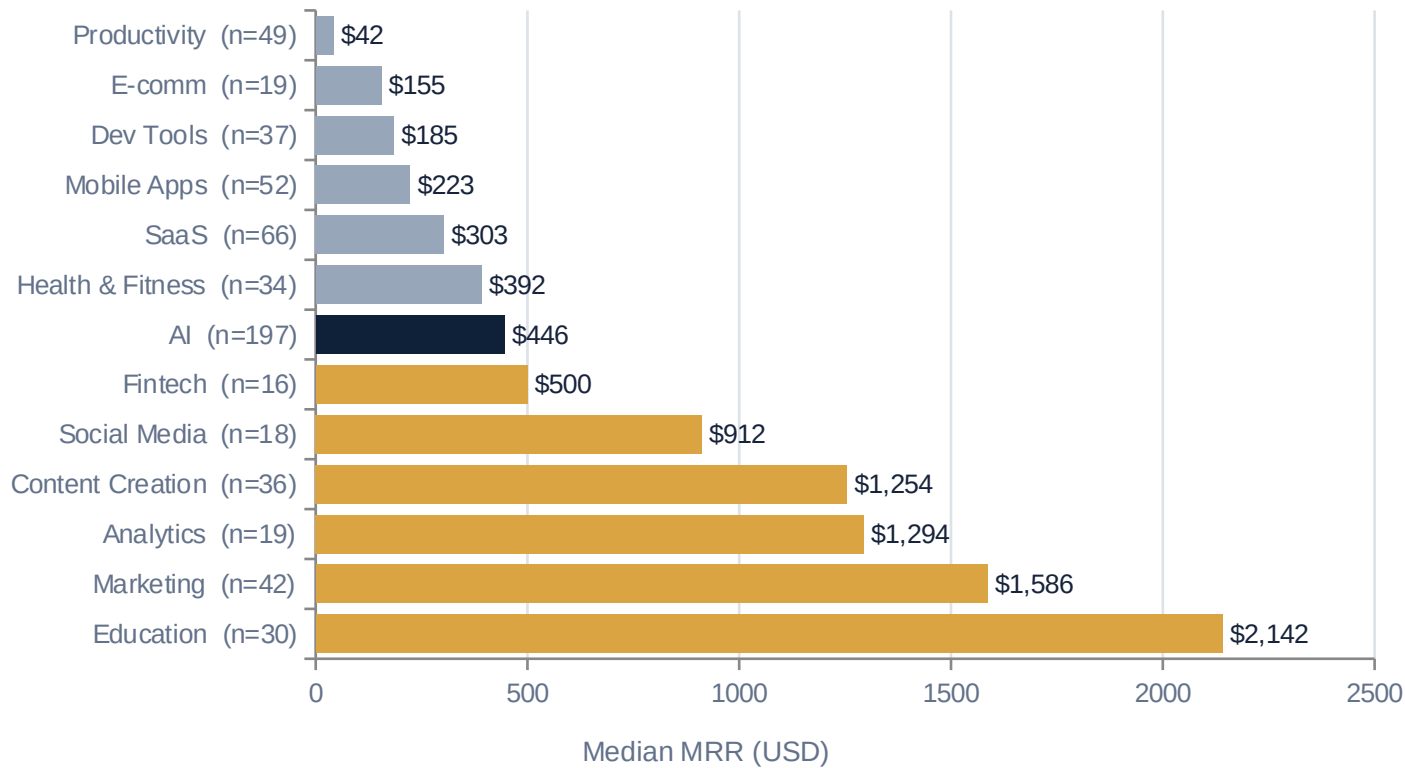
39.4% earn under \$100/month

Only 9.3% earn \$25K+/month

AI is most populous — but not most lucrative

SO WHAT Headcount in a category is not a quality signal. Distribution is.

AI is most populous — but Education, Marketing and Analytics all beat it on median MRR



CATEGORIES THAT BEAT AI

Education

30 listings · \$2,142 median

4.8× AI's median

Marketing

42 listings · \$1,586 median

3.6× AI's median

Analytics

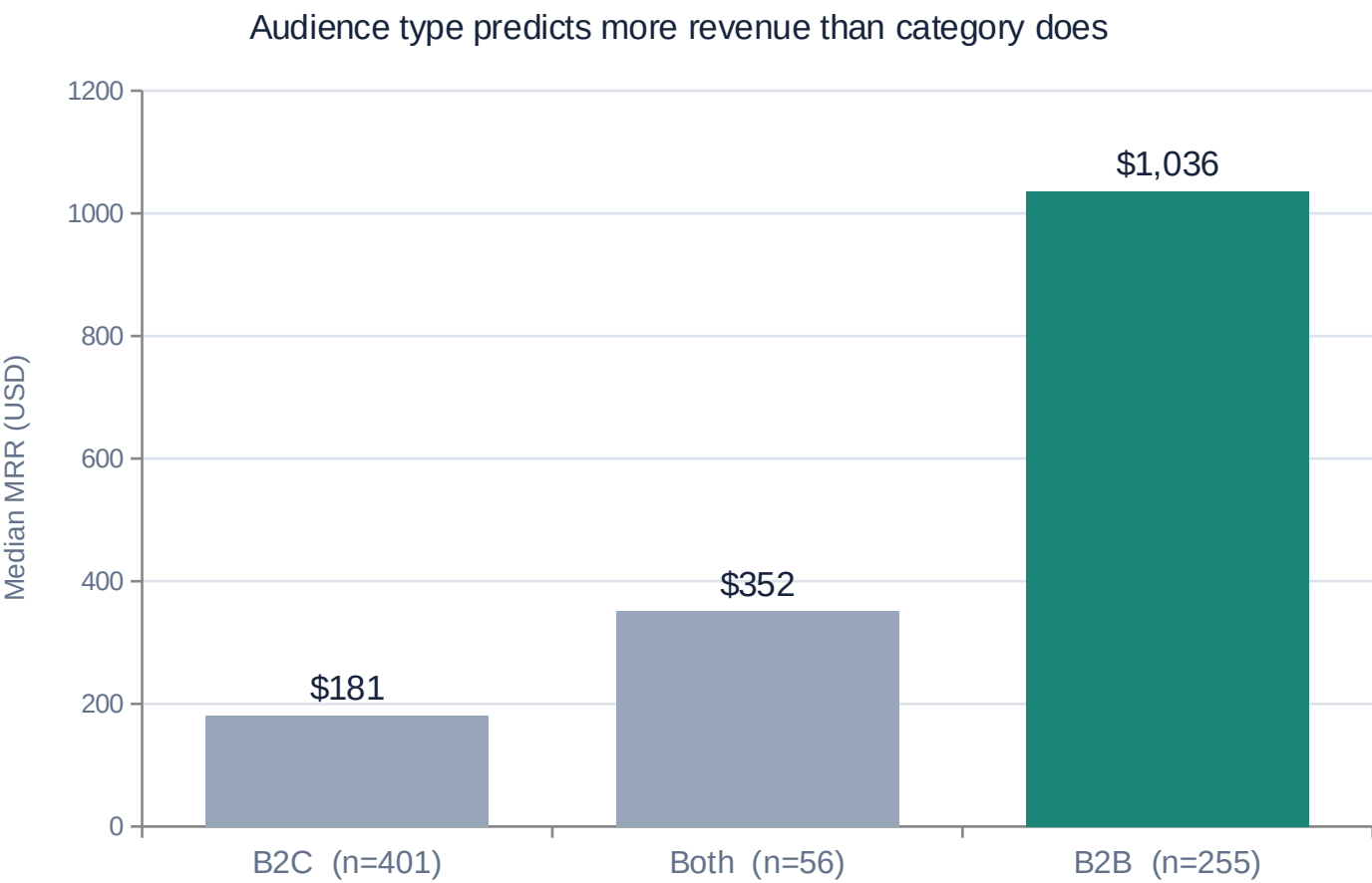
19 listings · \$1,294 median

2.9× AI's median

AI's own median: \$446 (n=197)

Audience type beats category

SO WHAT What you're selling to matters more than what category you've picked.



MEDIAN MRR BY AUDIENCE

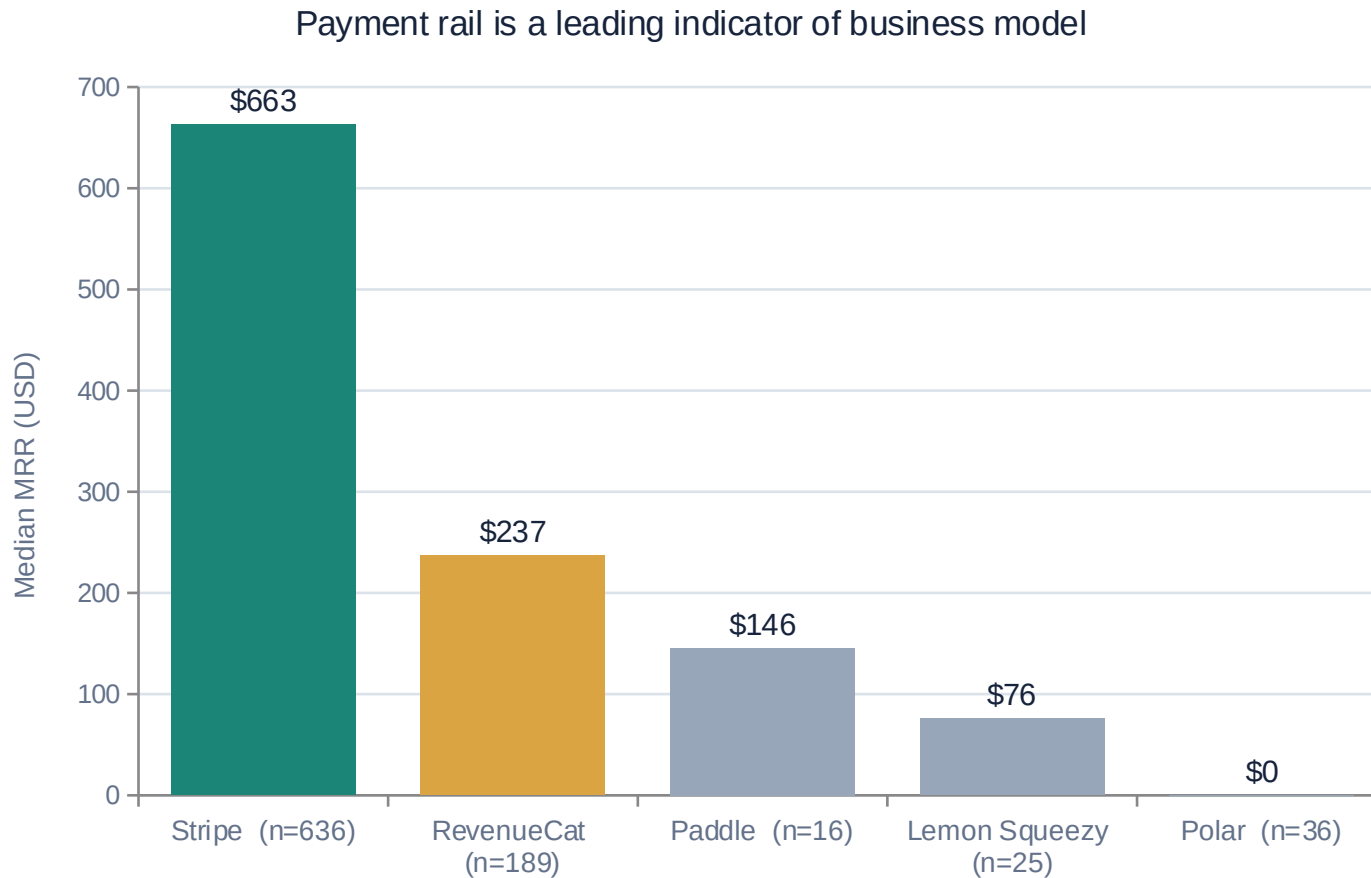
B2B	\$1,036
255 listings	
Both	\$352
56 listings	
B2C	\$181
401 listings	

B2B is 5.7× B2C on median MRR

Audience_type field missing for 288/1,000 listings. Use directional, not universal.

Payment rail is a business-model proxy

SO WHAT Stripe = web SaaS. RevenueCat = mobile. The rail already tells you the ceiling.



READ LIKE A CHECK

Stripe (n=636)

Median \$663 — web SaaS, stable ceiling

RevenueCat (n=189)

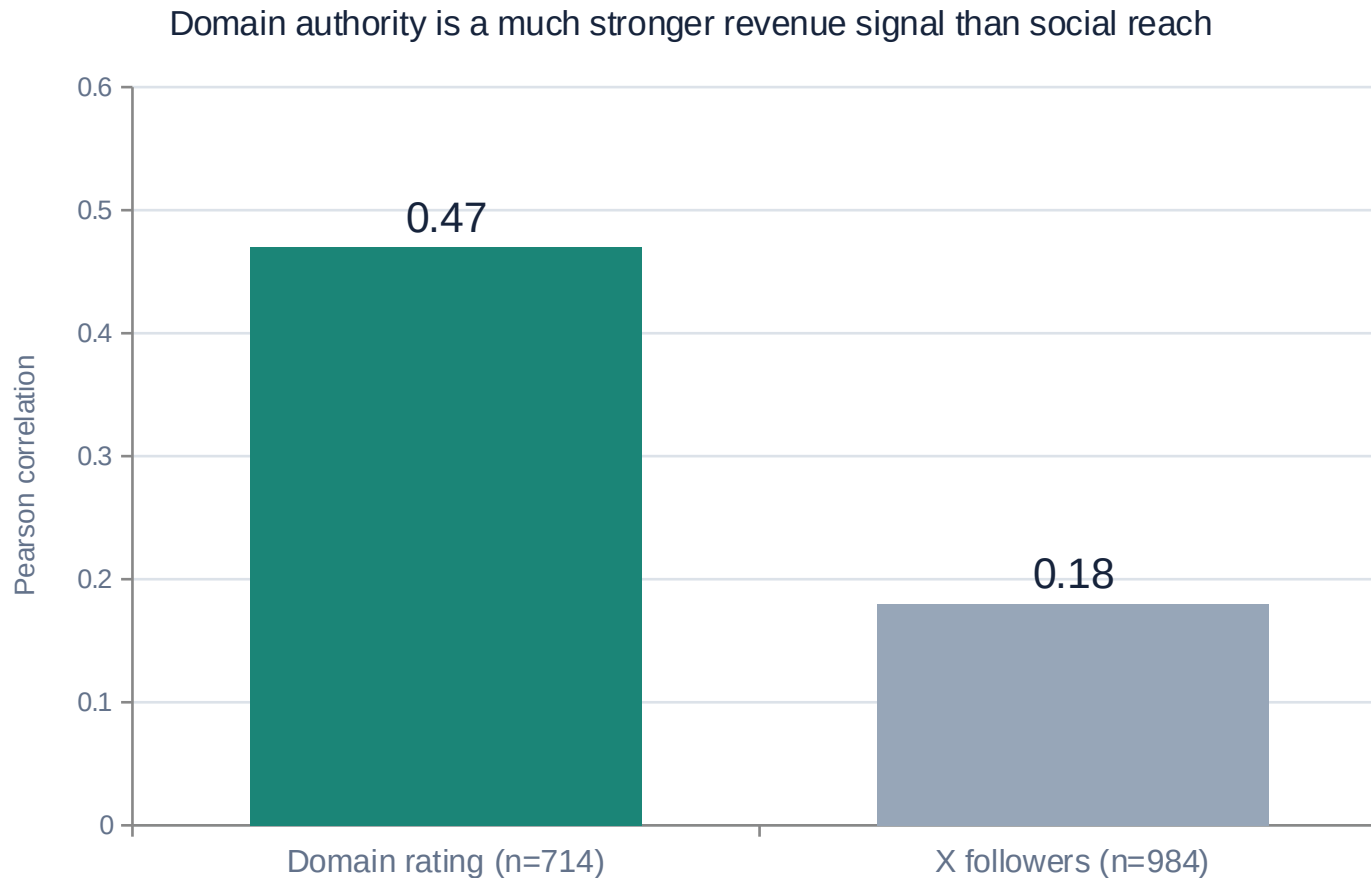
Median \$237 — mobile-first, app-store dynamics

Paddle / Lemon Squeezy / Polar (n=77)

Medians \$146 / \$76 / \$0 — creator/indie tier

Domain authority beats social reach

SO WHAT SEO compounds with revenue. Followers don't. Track the former.



PEARSON r VS LOG(MRR)

Domain rating

$r = 0.47$

n=714

X followers

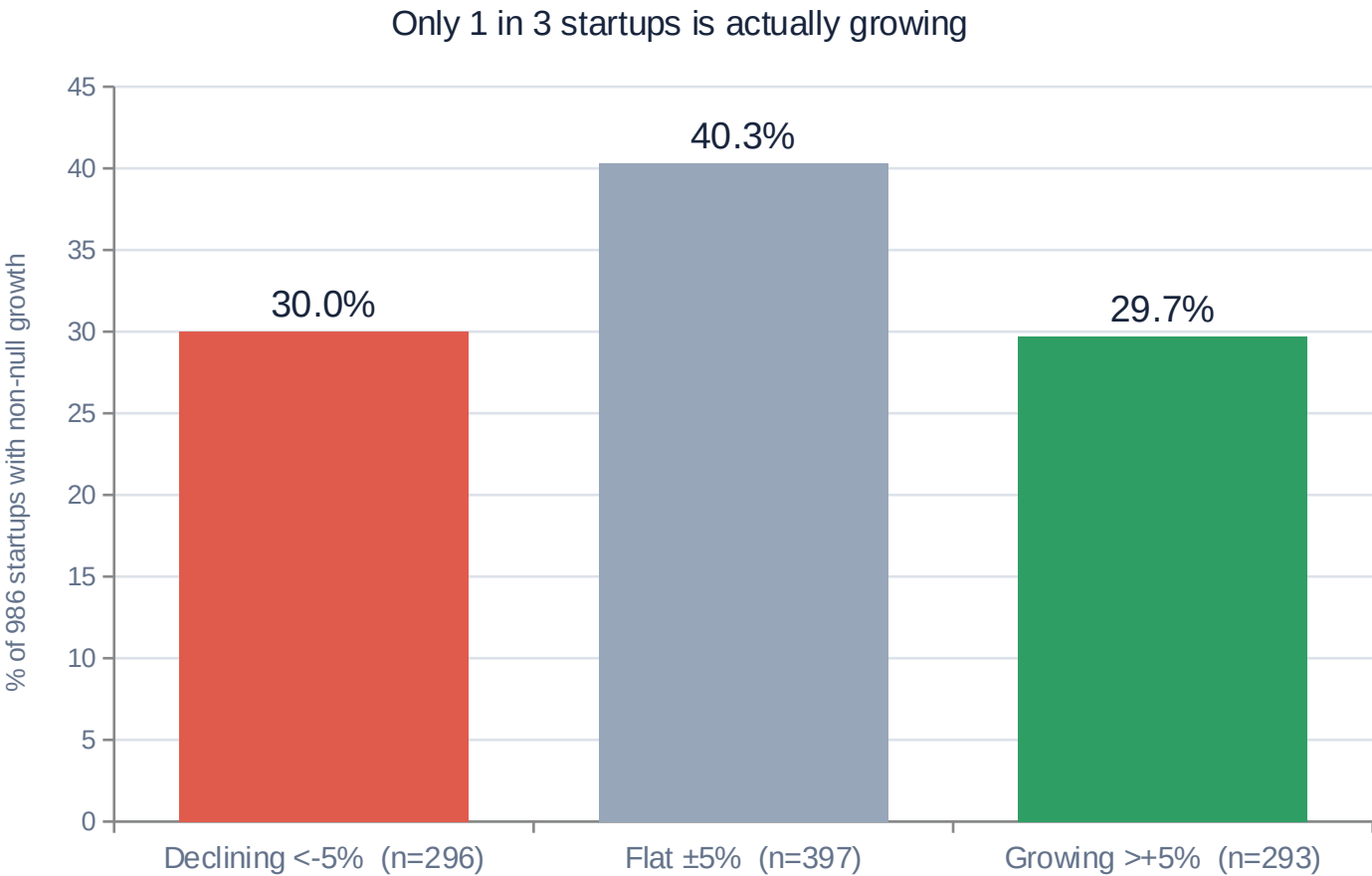
$r = 0.18$

n=984

Domain authority is 2.6× stronger than follower count.

Only 1 in 3 startups is actually growing

SO WHAT 'Growing' growth rates on tiny bases are mostly noise, not signal.



30-DAY GROWTH BUCKETS (±5% noise band)

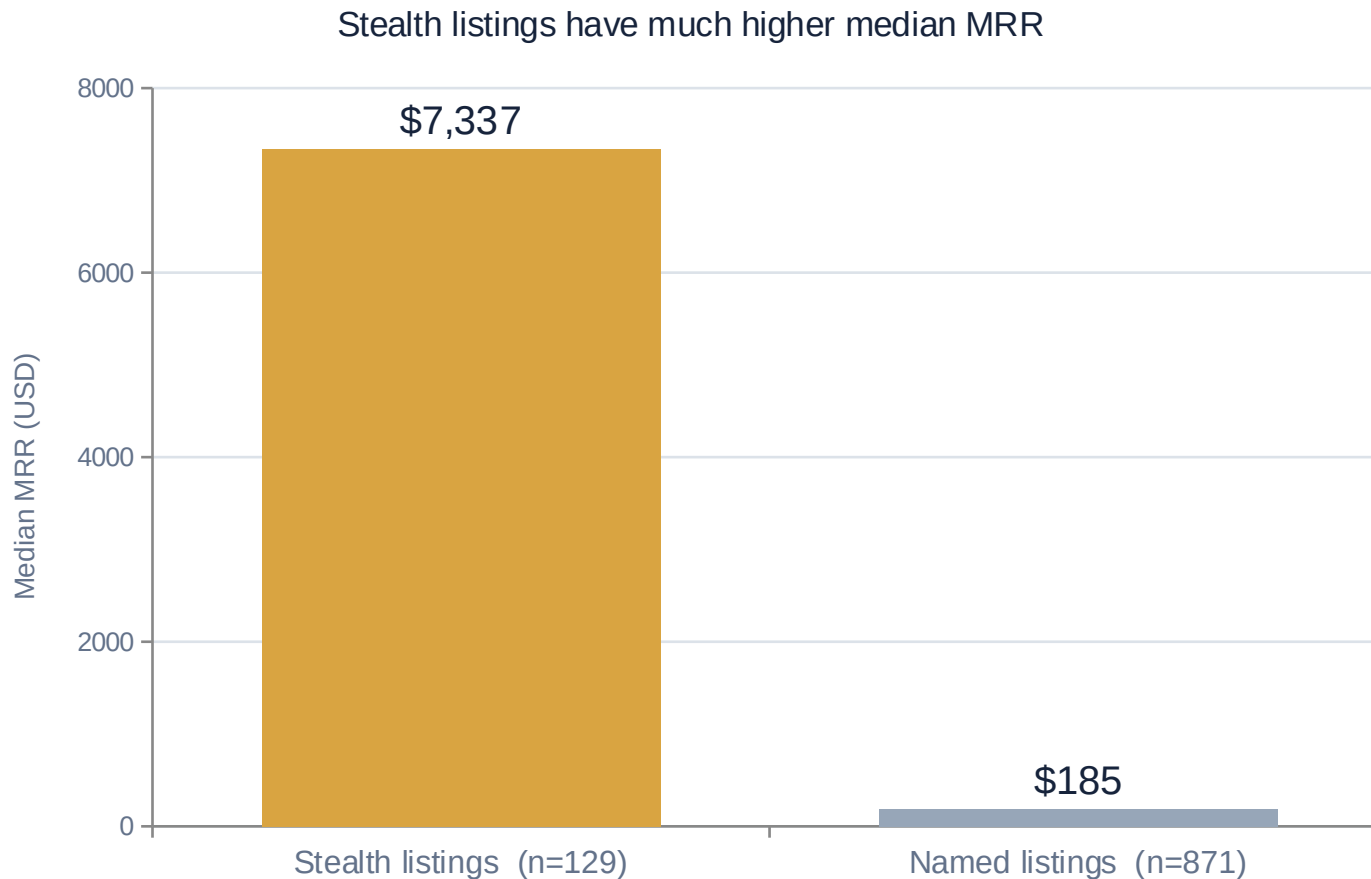
Growing >+5%	29.7%
n=293	
Flat ±5%	40.3%
n=397	
Declining <-5%	30%
n=296	

67 listings post 100%+ growth.

Their median MRR is just \$384 — small-base noise, not momentum.

Stealth is a top-100 marker, not a red flag

SO WHAT Founders stay anonymous while they still have leverage. The numbers say so.



Stealth listings median MRR \$7,337 vs \$185 for named listings — a 40× gap.

Source: TrustMRR dataset · frozen 30 Jul 2026 · N=1,000

ANONYMITY IS A TOP-100 MARKER

129/1,000 listings (12.9%)

12.9%

are anonymous

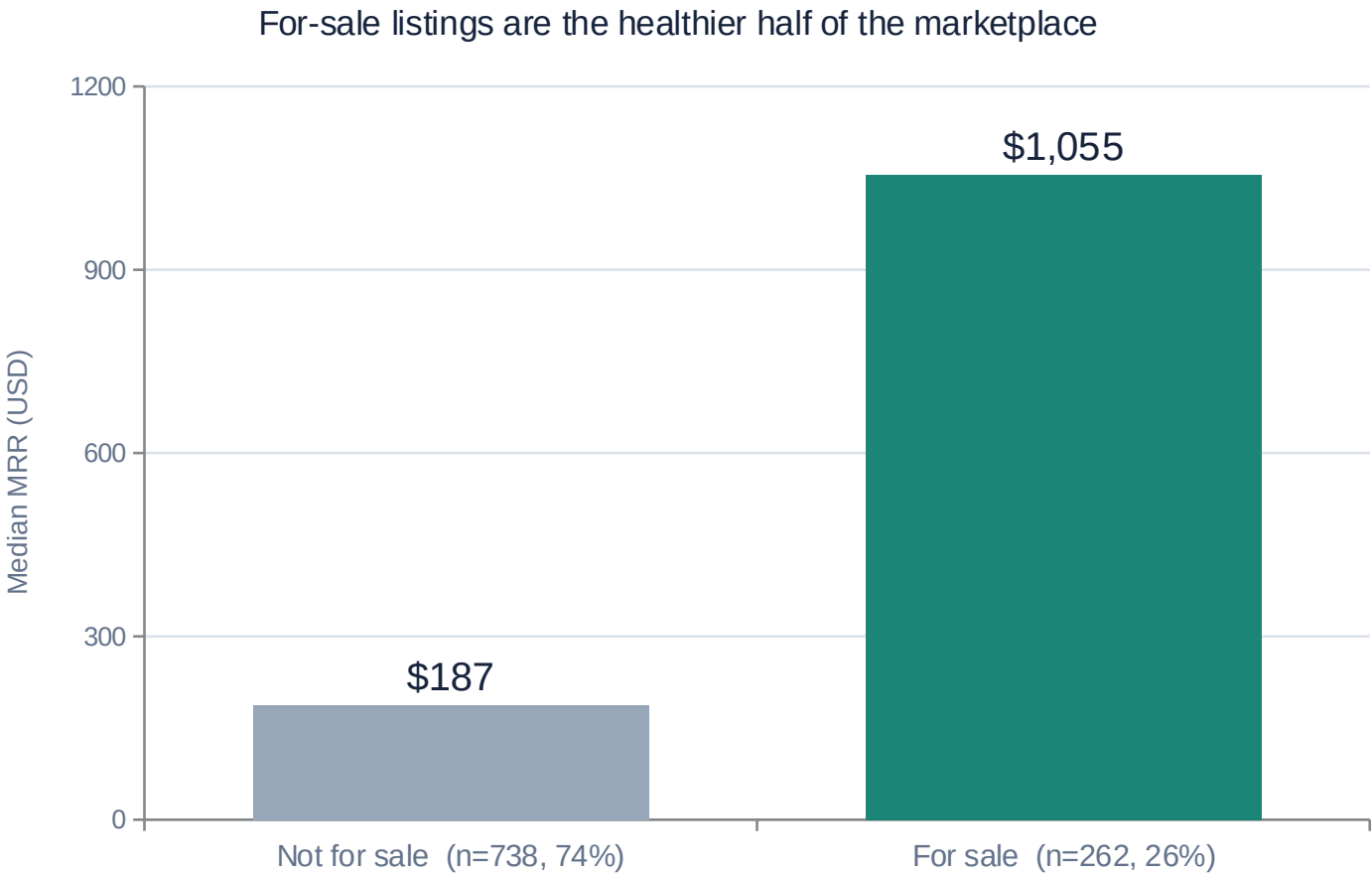
...but 36 of the top 100 are stealth

30%

of top-100 MRR is stealth

For-sale listings are the healthier half

SO WHAT Sellers in this market are marketing winners — not exit-by-exhaustion.



MARKETPLACE PULSE

262 listings are for sale

26.2% of the dataset

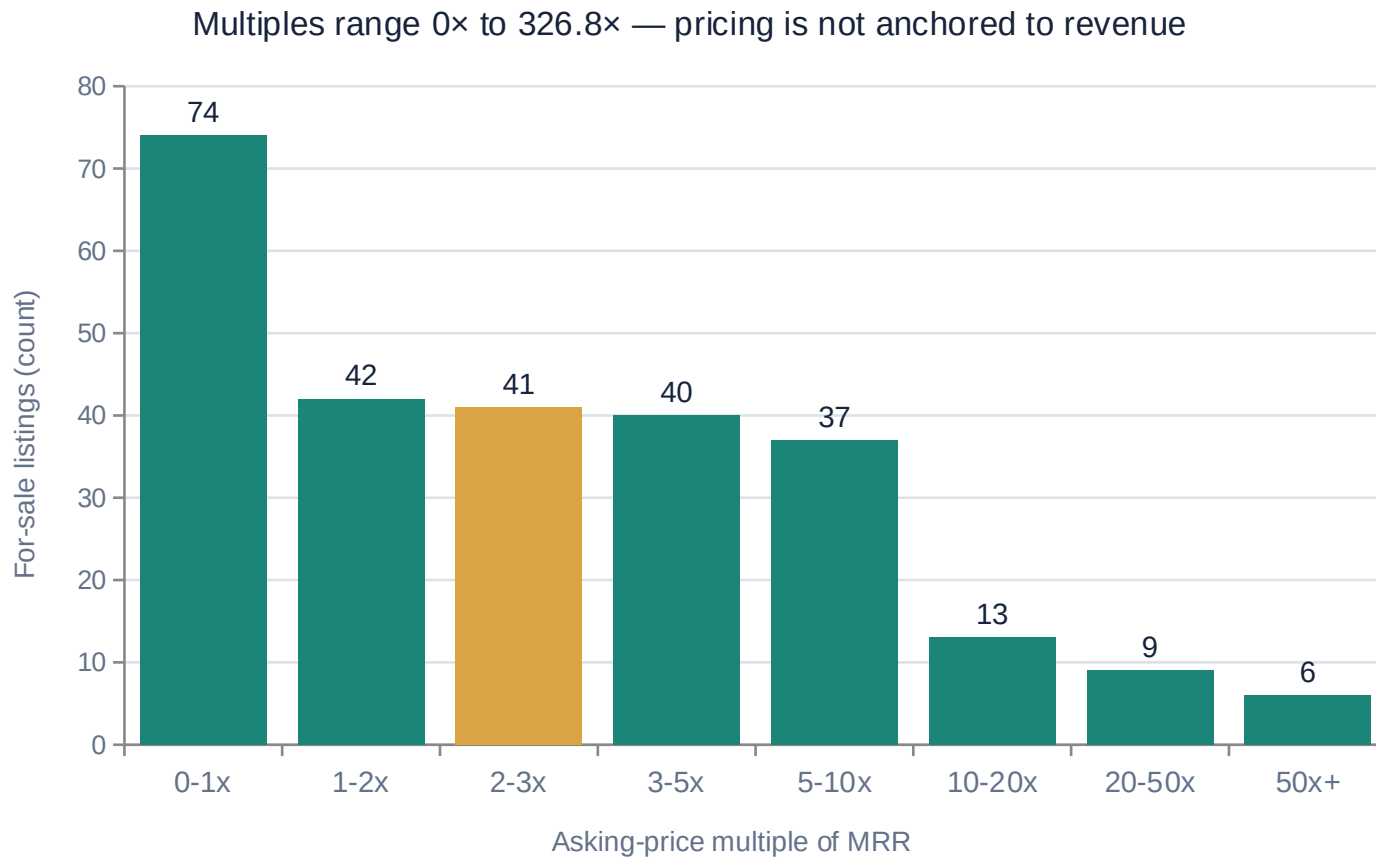
For-sale median MRR: \$1,055

Not-for-sale median MRR: \$187

For-sale businesses earn 5.6× more on the median.

Asking prices are not anchored to revenue

SO WHAT Two listings of similar MRR can carry 100×-different price tags.



ASKING-PRICE MULTIPLE OF MRR

Range

0× to 326.8×

across 262 disclosed listings

Median

2.3×

75th percentile still only 5×

Buyers should underwrite, not trust prices.

Four things leaders should do with this

SO WHAT Use these signals to allocate, evaluate and underwrite — not to chase buzz.

1

Don't chase category hype

AI is the largest cohort (n=197) but posted only \$446 median MRR. Education, Marketing and Analytics all beat it on the metric that matters.

2

Audience and channel matter more

B2B median \$1,036 vs B2C \$181 — a 5.7× gap from picking the right customer, before anything else. Stripe rails track higher than mobile-first rails.

3

Domain rating is a leading indicator

$r=0.47$ vs $\log(\text{MRR})$; X followers come in at $r=0.18$. Track the former in your funnel and deprioritise the latter as a buying signal.

4

The for-sale shelf is the healthy shelf

26% of listings are for sale and they're 5.6× more productive on median MRR. When you target acquisitions, target this shelf first.

Where the data is thinner than it looks

SO WHAT Half the dataset is missing on at least one important field. Plan accordingly.

Field	Non-null	Missing	% missing	What this means
category	726	274	27.4%	Slide 5 is a healthy-cohort view; not a full-population ranking.
country	759	241	24.1%	No reliable geo claim from this dataset.
audience_type	712	288	28.8%	Slide 6 B2B/B2C excludes ~29% of listings.
domain_rating	714	286	28.6%	Slide 8 correlation large-sample but not full-sample.
revenue_growth_30d_pct	986	14	1.4%	Slide 9 buckets are well-supported.
visitors_30d	178	822	82.2%	No traffic-based claim is possible from this data.
asking_price_usd	261	739	73.9%	Slide 12 is conditional on listings that disclosed a price.

Thank You

Revenue in this market is concentrated, category hype is a poor proxy for value, and a handful of durable signals — audience type, payment rail, domain authority — separate the businesses that matter from the listings that don't.

Revenue is winner-take-most — the top 10% of listings capture 82% of total MRR; the bottom 75% share just 3%.

Category hype misleads — AI is the largest cohort by count (n=197) but ranks below Education, Marketing and Analytics on median revenue.

Signal beats noise — audience type, payment rail and domain authority predict revenue far better than category or social following.

Growth is the exception — only 3 in 10 startups are genuinely growing once small-base noise is excluded.

Health hides in plain sight — both the for-sale shelf and anonymous “stealth” listings skew healthier, not riskier.

PREPARED BY

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